

Pedro I. R. Luz de Castro

Updated: July 31, 2026

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science 6756 Haven Hall 505 South State Street Ann Arbor, MI 48104	Phone: 734-492-2304 Email: pldc@umich.edu Website: pedroluzdecastro.com
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Political economy of development; state formation and state capacity; political geography; territorial and criminal governance.	
EDUCATION	University of Michigan , Ann Arbor, MI Ph.D., Political Science M.A., Applied Economics University of Brasília , Brasília, Brazil LL.M., Law LL.B., Law	Expected 2028 2025 2022 2018
WORKS IN PROGRESS	“Fiscal Extraction under Partial Sovereignty: Evidence from Criminal Territories in Rio de Janeiro” Examines when territorial control translates into fiscal extraction and how transaction mobility constrains that power. Uses staggered territorial takeovers and spatial price data from Rio de Janeiro.	
SELECTED RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS	Political Economy and the Environment Group, University of Michigan Interdisciplinary Workshop on Comparative Politics, University of Michigan	April 2026 2025
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	<i>Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan</i> International Economic Relations Introduction to Comparative Politics Data Science for International Studies Introduction to World Politics Quantitative Empirical Methods of Political Science <i>Instructional Aide, ICPSR Summer Program</i> Introduction to Python Introduction to the R Statistical Computing Environment Programming for Legal Research Workshop, University of Brasília	Fall 2024 Winter 2024 Fall 2023 Winter 2023 Fall 2022 Summer 2023 Summer 2023 2020
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Graduate Student Research Assistant <i>Supervisor: George Tsebelis</i> Graduate Student Research Assistant <i>Supervisor: Robert J. Franzese, Jr.</i> Graduate Student Research Assistant <i>Supervisor: Deborah Beim</i>	2024–Present Summer 2023 Summer 2022

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS AND HONORS	Oskar Morgenstern Fellowship, Mercatus Center	2023–2024
	ISR–Rackham Summer Training Award	2023
	Graduate Research Fellowship, University of Brasília	2019–2021
	Undergraduate Research Fellowship, University of Brasília	2015–2016
SERVICE	Graduate Student Coordinator, Political Economy Workshop	2024–Present
	Graduate Student Coordinator, Interdisciplinary Workshop on Comparative Politics	2024–2025
	Graduate Admissions Committee, Department of Political Science	2023–2024
	Editor, University of Brasília Student Law Review	2017
SKILLS	<i>Technical:</i> Python, R, git, Stata, TeX <i>Language:</i> Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate)	
REFERENCES	Mark Dincecco Professor Political Science University of Michigan dincecco@umich.edu	George Tsebelis Professor Political Science University of Michigan tsebelis@umich.edu
	Edgar Franco-Vivanco Assistant Professor Political Science University of Michigan efrancov@umich.edu	Cesi Cruz Associate Professor Political Science University of Michigan cesi@umich.edu